

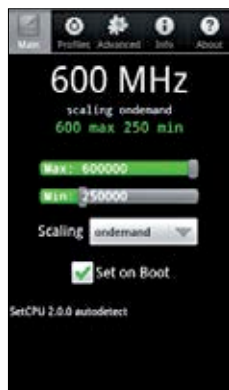
usually happen, but to be on the safer side, it is highly recommended that you backup all of your phone's data including your contacts, messages and applications (along with application data). Contacts are usually backed up by Google within your Gmail account, but if you want to be extra sure, you can export your contacts as a .vcf file to your SD card. This backup can be moved to a safe location and can be used to restore your contacts by importing your contacts from this file. Messages can be backed up using SMS Backup and Restore, which exports your messages along with their metadata to an .xml file on your SD card. Applications can be backed up using ES file explorer or Astro file manager.

Why should I root my phone?

As discussed before, rooting unleashes the full potential of your phone giving you features from apps that were earlier unavailable. Apps can interact with much more advanced aspects of your phone, giving you almost limitless control over your device. As an example, we've listed the top 10 hacks you can use to gain control of your rooted phone. Naturally, all these hacks require you to be rooted with the Superuser binary installed.

1. Control your CPU

Modern smartphones come with powerful CPUs with clock speeds in GHz and advanced frequency scaling features. Apps like SetCPU can change the scaling limits of your phone, allowing you to overclock it for better performance, or to underclock it to save battery life. Bear in mind though, that this is a highly risky task, and changing the parameters outside the device's limits could be disastrous.



Overclock your CPU with SetCPU

2. Securely backup apps/ move apps to SD card

Apps like Titanium Backup / ROM Toolbox let you create secure backups of your apps along with their data to your SD card. Titanium Backup can even export your backups to the cloud via your Dropbox or Box account. These apps also let you forcibly move apps from the phone's internal memory to the external (SD card) memory, a handy feature for lower-end devices.